

Prescription Drug Help

Can't afford your medications? You may be able to get them free or far cheaper through manufacturer programs, nonprofits, and discount tools. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Never skip or split doses to save money before checking these options — many people get the very same drug free or for a few dollars. Always ask your pharmacist about generics, too.

1 Find Programs for Your Medication

These directories match you to patient-assistance programs based on the exact drug you take.

☐ **NeedyMeds**

A free database of patient-assistance programs, plus a discount drug card and free-clinic directory.

→ www.needymeds.org

☐ **RxAssist**

A directory of drug-company programs that give medicines free or cheaply to people who qualify.

→ www.rxassist.org

☐ **Medicine Assistance Tool (PhRMA)**

Search hundreds of manufacturer assistance programs in one place.

→ medicineassistancetool.org

2 Lower the Price at the Pharmacy

Discount tools and low-cost generics can dramatically cut what you pay, even without insurance.

☐ **GoodRx — Compare & Save**

Free coupons and price comparisons that can cut prescription costs sharply. No membership needed.

→ www.goodrx.com

☐ **Cost Plus Drugs**

An online pharmacy selling many generics at very low, transparent prices.

→ costplusdrugs.com

☐ **Low-Cost Generic Lists**

Many pharmacies sell common generics for about \$4. Ask your pharmacy for its discount generic list.

→ **Ask your pharmacy**

3 Free Medicine for Those Who Qualify

Nonprofits and clinics provide free medications to low-income and uninsured patients.

☐ **SIRUM — Free Surplus Medicine**

A nonprofit that redirects unused, unexpired medicine to patients in need.

→ sirum.org/get-medications

☐ **Free & Charitable Clinics**

Many free clinics include prescription assistance. Find one near you.

→ www.needymeds.org/free-clinics

4 Help for Medicare & Seniors

Special programs lower drug costs for people on Medicare.

☐ **Medicare Extra Help (Low-Income Subsidy)**

Federal help paying Part D drug costs for people with limited income (up to 150% of poverty level).

→ www.ssa.gov/medicare/part-d-extra-help

☐ **State Pharmaceutical Assistance Programs**

Some states help residents pay for medications. Ask your SHIP counselor (see the Medicare guide).

→ www.medicare.gov/basics/costs/help/drug-costs

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Avoid websites that charge a “membership” to access drug discounts — GoodRx and the programs above are free. And never buy prescription drugs from unverified overseas sites; they can be unsafe.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Bring the discount price to your pharmacist — sometimes a coupon beats your insurance copay. And always ask if a generic version exists; it’s usually far cheaper and just as effective.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need local prescription help?

This guide covers national programs. For local clinics with pharmacy help and programs in your area, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
